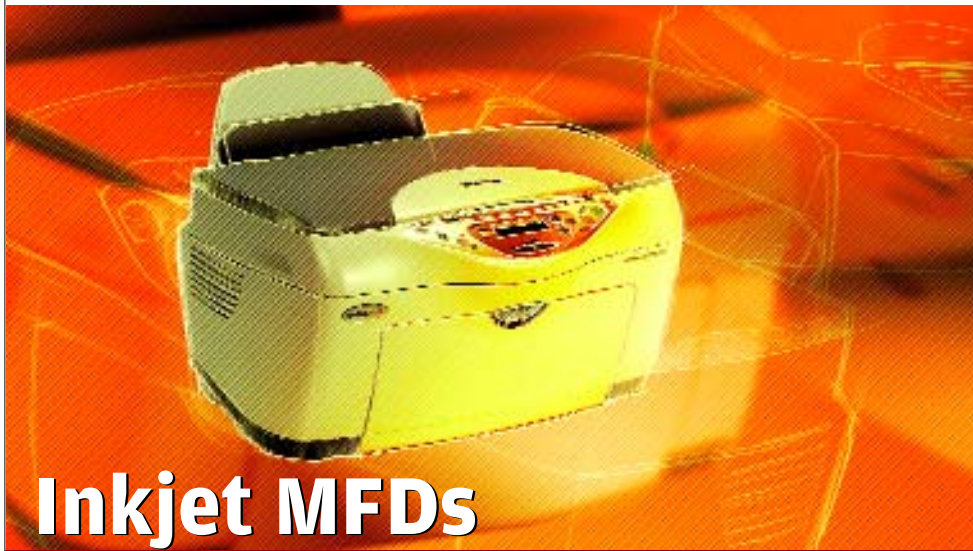




Inkjet MFDs

MFDs will gain a mass acceptance provided they become cost effective and provide better quality solutions. MEAP (Multi-functional Embedded Application Platform) is an upcoming technology developed by Canon to make Multifunctional Devices future-proof and easy—it's a JAVA-based platform which achieves several objectives, functionality is controlled by software making each functions to be used by the user easily available. Also communicating with your printer becomes vastly simplified with functions tailored to your workflow. Using MEAP you can also customized MFD with off the shelf application which is not possible with most units available right now.

Facts

❑ One disadvantage with MFD is that if one component breaks down the device won't function. Individual components—

the printer, scanner of a MFD cannot be separately upgraded.

❑ Simultaneous use of component in a MFD is possible, so the users can print, scan and fax at a same time. However printing and copy can't be done simultaneously as printer unit is needed even for copy purpose.

❑ Multifunction devices (MFDs) were created, combining printing, scanning, copying and often faxing—all in one. MFDs are cheaper than buying separate stand-alone devices, take up less space and need only one connector cable and one power outlet.

❑ For bulk usage it is advisable to invest in a Laser MFD over an inkjet MFD because the running cost of inkjet MFDs generally turn out on a higher side.

❑ The printing unit in most MFDs support only A4 size and hence for specialized application such as A3 printing you will need to rely on a standalone printer.



Buying Tips

✓ MFDs (Multi Functional Devices) is a combination of a printer, scanner, copier, and in some case a fax as well. Buying an MFD is a viable option only if you need all of these functions; entry-level MFDs provide cost effective solution.

✓ MFDs with more memory can accommodate more data in their queues without causing errors when data is sent for printing. If you are looking for an MFD that will be used by, say, 10 to 15 users, then opt for one which has at least 16 MB of RAM. Some MFDs, especially those targeted at

enterprises, support memory upgrade to greater levels.

✓ Buy a MFD that supports a high-speed USB 2.0 connection and comes equipped with a parallel connection (also known as the printer port) for porting it with older PCs.

✓ In case you intend to use it over a network, ensure that the MFD comes with appropriate software and accessories to do so.

✓ Some MFDs bundle OCR software to scan a document and save it as a specific file, such as a Microsoft Word document.

Ready Reckoner



You Need

MFDs for a SoHo business

Look for

At least a 600 x 600 dpi printer and 600 x 1,200 dpi scanner, stand-alone copying feature and low cost per page



You Need

MFDs for a small business

Look for

Automatic Document Feeder, dialpad for faxing, USB 2.0



You Need

MFDs for professional use

Look for

USB 2.0, direct printing from flash cards, support for highest possible resolution for image printing and copying

EPSON

❑ Most MFDs have scanner units that can only scan documents; if you need a TP scanner a standalone scanner unit is a must.

❑ Recently launched inkjet MFDs have support for memory cards and some are Pictbridge compliant, they make a good buy if you have a digital camera.

❑ Not all MFDs have fax feature, select few models have this facility. If you see the requirement coming up in the future it is better to buy a model with fax capability.

Also some MFDs have software driven faxing capability hence before buying read through the specifications properly to figure out what type of fax features are available.